EK-09 Budget Estimation Reference Ranges (Illustrative)

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1. Document metadata

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Data status	Illustrative estimates; not market prices
Main topics	Budget ranges; Effort ranges; Cost components
Relevant skills and technologies	Estimation
Relevant entity IDs	EST-001, EST-002, EST-003, EST-004, EVA-002

Purpose and scope: give illustrative effort ranges by project type and cost components for plausibility checks of proposal prices.

2. Executive summary

Ten project types have illustrative effort ranges. Client planning estimates in the fictional jobs lie inside the ranges. Ranges support plausibility checks and are not market prices.

3. Purpose of reference ranges

Reference ranges help an evaluator judge whether a proposal's scope and price are plausible. They are illustrative and depend on team, region, scope and quality targets; they are not market prices and must not be used as a single rule for every freelancer.

4. Illustrative effort ranges by project type

Assumptions: one freelancer, USD currency, estimation version v1.0 dated 2026-10-14, medium requirement stability, testing and handover included.

Project type	Fictional job	Effort range (h)	Client planning estimate (h)	Preferred maximum (USD)	Preferred max per planning hour (USD/h)
Angular dashboard (low)	JOB-002	150-250	200	4,000	20
Storefront refresh (medium)	JOB-009	200-300	260	6,000	23
Web ordering portal (medium)	JOB-001	300-450	420	9,000	21
Marketplace MVP (high)	JOB-007	650-900	800	15,000	19
Performance tuning (low)	JOB-008	80-150	120	3,500	29
CI/CD hardening (low)	JOB-010	100-170	140	4,000	29
Kubernetes migration (medium)	JOB-004	200-320	240	7,000	29
Flutter booking app (medium)	JOB-005	300-420	380	8,000	21
Recommender (medium)	JOB-006	250-400	320	9,000	28

Project type	Fictional job	Effort range (h)	Client planning estimate (h)	Preferred maximum (USD)	Preferred max per planning hour (USD/h)
RAG assistant (high)	JOB-003	350-550	480	12,000	25

5. Using the ranges

- Compare the proposal's planned hours with the range for its project type.
- If hours are far below the range, check which work packages are excluded (testing, deployment).
- If the client budget per planning hour is low, expect fewer proposals within budget; this is a client-side risk, not a freelancer defect.
- Do not infer a freelancer's skill from a price alone.

6. Cost components

Component	Share of effort (illustrative)
Requirements and design	8%
Core build	50%
Integration	10%
Testing and defect fixing	15%
Deployment and handover	10%
Contingency	7%

These shares match the proposal breakdowns in FP-01 to FP-03.

7. Currency and rate caveats

Hourly rates vary widely. A price per hour derived from a proposal is an implied rate that mixes scope, risk and margin. Convert currencies only with a stated rate and date.

8. Evidence requirements and uncertainty

The assistant states that ranges are illustrative, cites EK-09 and EST-001 to EST-004, and does not present a range as a market fact.

9. Summary of key findings

- Ranges are illustrative.
- Price per hour is an implied figure.
- Low hours often indicate excluded work.

10. Keywords and alternative terminology

budget estimation; effort range; cost components; plausibility check; price range; implied rate